

Alla Vostra Mobile App Work Log – May 25, 2026 (Part 2)

Compiled summary for May 25, 2026 – focus: persistent-header overlay architecture, mobile shop reconstruction, carousel navigation repair, screen fade integration, and React Native parity with the website thin/mobile experience.

Current Baseline to Preserve

- Work resumed from a fresh GitHub reclone after Expo/Metro instability and corrupted local layout state.
- The overlay-header architecture is now the accepted baseline for Home, Products, About Us, Contact, and Shop.
- The Android 36-layer radial shadow system remains preserved exactly as finalized during May 23 Part 1.
- The mobile app continues to emulate the thin-width desktop website version wherever feasible.
- The shop screen intentionally hides the white carousel nav and background3 hero while preserving the orange brand bar.

Main Goals We Worked Toward

- Eliminate the mysterious whitespace clipping issue below background3.png.
- Match the website thin-width architecture more closely across all primary screens.
- Repair swipe-navigation order and looping behavior.
- Reconstruct the Shop screen to visually match the website thin/mobile version.
- Introduce a reusable romantic fade-overlay aesthetic without fading the AppHeader itself.

Persistent Header Investigation

The largest technical breakthrough during this session was identifying that the whitespace clipping issue was not caused by PNG transparency or background colors. Instead, the issue originated from React Native layout reservation inside the AppHeader hero wrapper. Transform animations altered the visual pixels of background3.png but did not affect the physical layout height reserved by the wrapper View. The final accepted direction overlays AppHeader above the screen content while manually padding the content underneath it. This more closely mirrors the desktop website logic, where the hero image and the main content shift are treated as separate systems.

Overlay Header Architecture

File	Purpose	Result
mob/app/_layout.js	Overlay AppHeader on main screens	Removed clipping block
sharedStyles.js	Explicit top content padding	Preserved visual spacing
productsStyles.js	Products overlay alignment	Products stabilized
shop.js	Shop overlay architecture	Removed shop clipping issue

Carousel Navigation Repair

The carousel swipe system initially behaved inconsistently because the PanResponder closure captured stale navigation indexes during initialization. This caused Products and Contact to reload themselves instead of navigating properly. The final repair introduced refs to track the current active page and index dynamically. Swiping now correctly loops: Home → Products → About Us → Contact → Home and in reverse: Home → Contact → About Us → Products → Home

Shop Screen Reconstruction

The Shop screen was rebuilt to emulate the website thin/mobile version as closely as possible. The accepted direction intentionally keeps only the orange brand banner visible at the top while removing the white carousel navigation row and background3 hero image. The mobile shop implementation now includes:

- truck1.png, bargain.png, and soffo.png shipping illustrations.
- Dream Avenue headline typography.
- Large vertical orange shipping pills.
- Product imagery for Piccola, Sei Perfetto, and Buon Natale.
- Restored product-description paragraphs matching the website version.

Screen Fade System

A reusable ScreenFade component was added to create a romantic fade effect at the top and bottom of app screens. The fade initially covered the AppHeader itself, which caused unwanted header dimming. The final accepted direction lowered the ScreenFade z-index below the AppHeader and repositioned the top fade to begin underneath the white navigation row.

Important Constraints Going Forward

- Do not remove the overlay-header architecture from _layout.js unless replacing the entire system intentionally.
- Do not reintroduce AppHeader into normal layout flow for the main screens.
- Do not modify the Android 36-layer radial shadow baseline without explicit instruction.
- Keep the Shop screen visually isolated from the shared hero/background3 system.

- Preserve Dream Avenue and TT Fors typography throughout the mobile app.
- When asked for pfs, always print the full script rather than snippets.

Best Next Approach

The next phase should focus on animation refinement and visual polish rather than large-scale architectural changes. The overlay-header system now behaves similarly to the website thin-width implementation and has solved the persistent clipping issue that affected earlier React Native attempts. Future work should prioritize: • Improving subtle motion polish. • Refining fade timing. • Enhancing image transition smoothness. • Continuing visual parity with the desktop website thin/mobile experience.

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